

SESSION 1 — EXPLOSIVITY

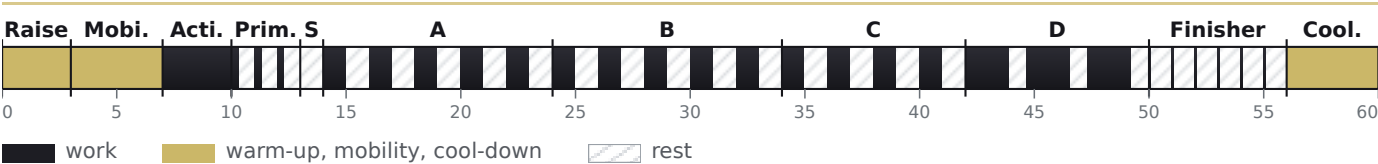
60 minutes · plyometric bias · high nervous-system cost · needs a bench, a flat 10 m strip, six cones, a tape measure, an overhead branch or bar

The point of this session is rate of force development: how fast you can produce force, not how much. That means low reps, maximum intent on every one, and long rests that feel wasteful. If you finish this session exhausted, you ran it wrong — you should finish it fresh and a little twitchy.

Marker for the log: best standing broad jump, in centimeters, measured in block B round 1.

Stop rule: the moment landings get loud or jump distance drops more than about 10% off your best of the day, that block is finished. Walk to the next one.

Minute by minute



TIME	BLOCK	WORK AND REST
0:00-0:03	Raise	Easy jog, ~400 m, rising from a shuffle to a real jog · easy throughout
0:03-0:07	Mobility	Four movements, one minute each · easy throughout
0:07-0:10	Activation	One round, straight through · continuous work
0:10-0:13	Primer	Pogo ladder, 3 rounds · 20 s work / 40 s rest
0:13-0:14	Setup	Water. Set the cones: start line, then one every 2 m · rest
0:14-0:24	A — Vertical	5 rounds of 2 min · 60 s work / 60 s rest
0:24-0:34	B — Horizontal	5 rounds of 2 min · 60 s work / 60 s rest
0:34-0:42	C — Fencing transfer	4 rounds of 2 min · 60 s work / 60 s rest
0:42-0:50	D — Upper body and trunk	3 rounds of 2:40 · 115 s work / 45 s rest
0:50-0:56	Finisher	6 rounds on the minute · 6 s work / 54 s rest
0:56-1:00	Cool-down	Stretch and breathe · easy throughout

0:00–0:03 · Raise

Easy throughout

Jog a loop of roughly 400 m. Start slower than feels natural and finish at a pace you could hold a conversation at. Arm circles forward for the first lap, backward for the second.

0:03–0:07 · Mobility, one minute each, no rest between

Easy throughout

1. **World's greatest stretch**, 30 s each side. Lunge, forearm to the instep, then open the chest to the ceiling and hold two breaths.
2. **Deep squat pry**, 60 s. Sit into the bottom of a squat, elbows inside the knees, and rock side to side. Heels stay down; if they lift, hold a post.
3. **Leg swings**, 15 front-to-back each leg, then 15 across the body each leg.
4. **Ankle rock-overs**, 20 each side. Front foot on the bench, drive the knee forward past the toes, heel glued down.

0:07–0:10 · Activation, one round straight through

Continuous work

- 12 glute bridges, two-second squeeze at the top
- 10 band lateral walks each direction, band above the knees
- 10 scapular push-ups (arms locked, only the shoulder blades move)
- 20 s dead hang from the bar, shoulders pulled down away from the ears

0:10–0:13 · Primer — pogo ladder

3 × 20 s work / 40 s rest

Three rounds: 20 s of pogo hops, 40 s walking. Knees nearly straight, all the bounce from the ankle, hands on the hips. The cue is sound: each contact should be one short tap, not a thud. If you cannot hear the difference, you are landing too heavy to start the session.

0:14–0:24 · Block A — Vertical power

5 × 60 s work / 60 s rest

Five rounds, two minutes each, starting on the clock.

- **3 countermovement jumps**. Stand, dip fast, jump as high as you can, reach one hand up. Stand fully upright and reset between each — no rhythm.
- 20 s rest.
- **4 depth drops from the bench**. Step off (do not jump off), land in a quiet quarter-squat, hold for one second. Rounds 1 and 2 are absorb only. Rounds 3, 4 and 5 add an immediate jump out of the landing.
- Walk and breathe for the rest of the two minutes.

Before round 1, find an overhead reference you can only just touch at full stretch on a maximal jump: a low branch, a sign edge, the underside of the bar. Touch it in round 1 and you should still be touching it in round 5. If you cannot, stop the block — that is the whole test.

Easier: skip the depth drops, do jumps to a target instead. Harder: step off from a higher ledge, no more than mid-thigh, still landing quiet.

0:24–0:34 · Block B — Horizontal power



5 × 60 s work / 60 s rest

Five rounds, two minutes each. Horizontal power is the one that matters most to a lunge, so this is the block to be fussy about.

- **3 standing broad jumps.** Stick each landing for a full two seconds before you move. In round 1, drop a cone at your best heel landing and measure back to the start cone with the tape — that is the session marker. Leave the cone there; rounds 2 to 5 are trying to reach it.
- 20 s rest.
- **20 m of alternate-leg bounding,** two lengths of the strip. Maximum distance per stride, arms driving, count your strides. Fewer strides over the same distance is the improvement.
- Walk back and breathe out the rest of the two minutes.

Easier: replace bounding with 10 m of exaggerated skipping for distance. Harder: rounds 4 and 5 become single-leg bounds, 10 m per leg, on grass only.

0:34–0:42 · Block C — Fencing transfer



4 × 60 s work / 60 s rest

Four rounds, two minutes each: roughly 60 s of work, then walk the rest. Every rep starts from a real en garde and ends balanced enough to move again.

- **Round 1 — 6 explosive advance-lunges.** Back leg drives, front heel lands first, no drift of the rear foot. Full stop between reps.
- **Round 2 — 6 balestra-lunges.** The balestra is a short jump, not a long one; land already loaded.
- **Round 3 — 6 retreat-lunges.** Retreat first, then attack out of the retreat without a pause to gather. This is the one most people cheat.
- **Round 4 — 6 reprises.** Lunge, recover forward, immediately lunge again.

No flèche in this block on a hard surface. On grass, round 4 may be replaced with 6 flèches — épée fencers only.

0:42–0:50 · Block D — Upper body and trunk



3 × 115 s work / 45 s rest

Three rounds, 2 minutes 40 seconds each: work straight through, then rest what is left (about 45 s).

- 5 explosive push-ups — hands leave the ground, clap optional. From the bench if the floor version is not clean.
- 5 explosive pull-ups, pulling as high as you can each rep. Jumping pull-ups with a slow lower are a legitimate substitute.

- 8 band chop throws each side, band anchored high on a post, finishing across and down past the opposite hip. Fast, but never at the end of your range.
- 20 s side plank each side, hips stacked and lifted.

0:50–0:56 • Finisher — six shots



6 × 6 s work / 54 s rest

Six rounds on the minute. Sprint 10 m from an en garde start, as hard as you can for about six seconds, then walk back and wait for the next minute. Start the first two from the right foot forward, then alternate.

This is short on purpose. The temptation is to make it a conditioning finisher; resist it. Today's session ends before fatigue arrives.

0:56–1:00 • Cool-down



Easy throughout

One minute of walking, then: couch stretch 45 s each side, hamstring on the bench 30 s each side, thoracic opener over the bench 30 s. Finish with four slow nasal breaths, five seconds in and eight out.

Log line

date · 01 explosivity · who · surface · broad jump __ cm · round-5 reach hit? y/n · felt __/10